

AT WORK · Graciela · 28 SEP 2026

Update Across Time: what happened, what is done, what is happening, what is next

Today's goal: Give a 60–90 second update about the certification process to your VP, using the right verb form for each part: what happened · what is done so far · what is happening now · what is next. And this time, you speak — you don't stay quiet.

Block 1 · Narrative Flow

First, read each sentence and correct it yourself. Then we decide together: is it **Fossilized** (you know the rule, but it comes out wrong) or a **Gap** (a new rule)?

Full sentence	Error	Correction	Type
"We had visited three consultants." (talking about last week)	had visited three consultants	We had three consultants with us last week.	Gap (HAVE)
"This Friday I quiet." (about the board meeting)	I quiet	On Friday I stayed quiet.	Fossilized
"He's not accepted the new deadline." (about Friday)	He's not accepted	He didn't accept the new deadline.	Fossilized
"We have presented the directory the schedule." (last Friday)	have presented the directory	We presented the schedule to the board on Friday.	Fossilized
"My manager needs the deadline is five months."	needs the deadline is	My manager wants it done in five months.	Fossilized

Rule: Every sentence needs ONE clear main verb in the right time. Watch your filler **"is the..."**: it is a verb that says nothing. Start with the subject + the real verb: **He didn't accept, I stayed, We**

presented. And some verbs go with fixed nouns: we **have** three consultants, we **have** a meeting, we **have** dinner.

→ Gap identificado: **HAVE + noun (fixed expressions)**. Lo trabajamos en el Bloque 2.

Block 2 · Language Clinic

HAVE as a main verb: have a coffee, have a meeting, have a call

The rule: HAVE has two jobs. (1) Helper: *have + past participle* → I **have** finished. (2) Main verb in fixed blocks: **have** a coffee, **have** a meeting, **have** a call. Learn the block, don't translate "tomar un café".

HAVE + food / drink	HAVE + work events	HAVE + situations
have a coffee · have lunch · have dinner	have a meeting · have a call · have consultants with us	have a problem · have a question · have a deadline

Examples with your words (your week with the consultants):

- We **had three consultants** with us from Tuesday to Friday.
- On Wednesday we **had dinner** with them: Peruvian-Asian fusion and two bottles of Carmenère.
- On Friday we **had a meeting** with the board.

Say these out loud:

1. We **have a deadline** in April.
2. We **have a problem**: the VP doesn't agree with the new date.
3. I **had a very intense week** with the consultants.
4. We haven't **had** an answer from the VP yet.
5. I usually **have lunch** at my desk when I'm very busy.

Your turn: Tell me about your week with the consultants in 4 sentences. Use HAVE + noun in each one (consultants, a meeting, dinner, a deadline, a problem...).

Block 3 · Skill: The English Verb System in a real update

Framework: WHAT HAPPENED → WHAT IS DONE SO FAR → WHAT IS HAPPENING NOW → WHAT IS NEXT. Start from the meaning, not from the name of the tense.

Meaning	Verb form	Example
What happened (finished time)	past simple	The consultants worked with us from Tuesday to Friday.
What is done so far (result now)	present perfect	We have prepared the general schedule.
What is happening now	present continuous	We are adding the details to each task.
What is still open	present perfect + yet	The VP hasn't accepted the April deadline yet.
What is next (plan)	going to	We are going to present the detailed plan next week.

Scenario 1 · Update the president

You: the person leading the certification with the three consultants.

Flor: the president of the company, who wasn't in the working sessions and wants a clear update.

Your task: explain where the certification is today — what happened last week, what is done, what is happening now and what is next.

Scenario 2 · The VP pushes back

You: the person who prepared the schedule with the consultants. On Friday you stayed quiet — today you speak.

Flor: the vice president. He wants January and thinks the tasks are simple.

Your task: answer each question first, in one sentence, then defend the April deadline with facts.

Questions you will hear: When did you start? · What have you finished? · What are you working on now? · Why isn't it January? · These tasks look simple — what are you going to do to finish sooner?

Guiding questions

1. What happened last week with the consultants? (a finished event)
2. What have you completed so far?

3. What are you working on right now?
4. What is still open? What hasn't the VP accepted yet?
5. What are you going to do next, and when?

Model (we look at it AFTER your first attempt)

Last week the consultants **worked** with us from Tuesday to Friday.

So far we **have prepared** the general schedule with all the critical tasks.

Right now we **are adding** the details to each task.

The VP **hasn't accepted** the April deadline **yet**.

Next week we **are going to present** the detailed plan to show why April is realistic.

Useful phrases

- Last week we... / Yesterday I...
- So far we have...
- Right now we are...
- We haven't ... yet.
- The next step is... / We are going to...
- I understand, but realistically...
- The critical tasks will be done by mid-April.
- If we rush it, the risk is...

My first version

My new version

Corrections

Block 4 · Pronunciation

The -ed ending: /t/ · /d/ · /ɪd/

From our last class: **worked**. From today: **stayed**, **presented**, **minimized**.

<i>/t/</i>	<i>/d/</i>	<i>/ɪd/</i> (extra syllable)
worked · finished · asked	stayed · reviewed · minimized	presented · accepted · completed

Only verbs that end in a /t/ or /d/ sound add an extra syllable: complet-**ed**. "Worked" is ONE syllable: /wɜ:kt/.

Say this sentence out loud 5 times: "We presented the schedule, the VP minimized the tasks, and I stayed quiet." Then the new version: "We presented the schedule and I explained why April is realistic."

Tarea

Ver el training The English Verb System y grabar un audio de 60–90 segundos con el update de la certificación para el VP (qué pasó · qué ya está hecho · qué está pasando ahora · qué sigue), defendiendo el deadline de abril; practicarlo una vez con el bot Flor English Coach.

Traer el audio y 3 frases propias con HAVE + sustantivo sobre la semana con los consultores a la próxima clase.